

US-Iran Conflict Briefing

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US Pulls Bombers From RAF Fairford After New Threat

- A Pentagon official confirmed on Sunday that all US bombers deployed to RAF Fairford have been re-deployed to their home stations in the United States. — [Reuters](#)
- A CNN source described the latest threat that prompted the withdrawal as a 'real world incident,' separate from the September 27 arrests near the base. — [CNN](#)
- The Times reports about a dozen B-1 bombers had been stationed at Fairford, with jets filmed leaving on Sunday — underlining how seriously Washington took the threat. — [The Times \(London\)](#)
- Background: five men arrested near Fairford on September 27 and a sixth, a dual British-Iranian national arrested October 1, have all been released on bail; British authorities say there were strong indications Iran played a part, which Tehran denies. — [Reuters](#)

FlyDubai Co-Pilot Probably Acted Alone, Israeli Sources Say

- Israeli sources told CNN that the co-pilot accused of attacking his colleague on FlyDubai flight FZ1073 and trying to seize the plane's controls probably acted alone. — [CNN](#)
- An Israeli official said the inquiry so far suggested the suspect acted alone, and another Israeli source said Israel currently knows of no link to any group or government — described as 'their understanding so far.' — [CNN](#)
- The finding materially weakens the claim made Thursday by President Trump that Iran could be linked to the attack 'based on what I'm hearing,' after which he warned of a 'very hard' US response if an Iranian link were confirmed. — [CNN](#)
- Background: the co-pilot attacked the captain with a crash ax on September 30; the plane plunged thousands of feet before the crew recovered control, and all 174 people aboard survived after a diversion to Saudi Arabia, where the co-pilot was detained. — [CNN](#)

Iran's Oil Minister Resigns

- Oil Minister Mohsen Paknejad resigned on Sunday; President Masoud Pezeshkian accepted and appointed National Iranian Oil Company chief executive Hamid Bovard as acting minister. — [Reuters](#)
- The presidential office said Paknejad had offered to resign 'a long time ago' for personal reasons and insisted on it; Pezeshkian accepted the resignation today. — [Reuters](#)
- Just before the news broke, Paknejad told state media that revenues from the oil Iran has sold 'are still coming and that will continue God willing.' — [Reuters](#)

Strikes on Shipping Surge Again in Hormuz

- The UK Maritime Trade Operations center reported seven strikes on vessels around Hormuz since September 28, plus another reported Sunday — all seven clustered near the narrowest part of the strait, according to the Wall Street Journal. — [WSJ](#)

- On Saturday, the IRGC Navy transmitted a warning on a public shipping channel to ships planning to use the US-backed route: 'Don't trust U.S. Navy and don't use south corridor at all and don't put your life in danger' — a radio message the Journal says it reviewed. — [WSJ](#)
- Gulf crude shipments had been recovering toward pre-war levels before the resurgence; UAE producers have been running shuttle-runs — loading inside the Gulf, exiting Hormuz, and transferring cargoes outside the strait. — [WSJ](#)

Markets

- Brent crude futures were quoted at \$102.55 a barrel in the October 4 read; Reuters' market report put Friday's Brent settle at \$102.25. — [Reuters](#)
- West Texas Intermediate futures were quoted at \$90.98 a barrel in the October 4 read; the Wall Street Journal reported Friday's WTI settle at \$91.11 and rounded it to \$91. — [WSJ](#)
- The US national average diesel price held at \$6.382 a gallon for the week ending September 28, per the EIA weekly retail survey; the next EIA weekly print, for the week ending October 5, publishes Monday. — [WSJ](#)

Related media



B-1B bombers at RAF Fairford (FlightGlobal photo); the bombers deployed there were withdrawn to US home stations on October 4 after a new threat. — [view original](#)

■ Iran's foreign minister Abbas Araqchi says sanctions and military action will not work, and urges talks (APT video of his Sunday address to foreign ambassadors in Tehran).

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